Tracy Chun

tracychun13@gmail.com | (646) 287- 0221 | LinkedIn | Portfolio | New York City, NY

Dear Hiring Manager,

I’m excited to apply for Ciena’s Technical Sales Development Program. I recently graduated from Rochester Institute of Technology with a B.S. in Game Design and Development. I want to build my career where technology meets the customer.

A game design degree may not look like the usual path into sales, but I see it as an advantage. There are a lot of similarities between game developers and sales. Every game is built for the players. Throughout my time at RIT, I was trained to cater and focus on the user. Learn what they want, watch where they struggle, and keep improving until the experience works for them. Sales engineering starts in the same place: the customer’s problem comes first.

Game development also taught me how to make complex systems feel simple. A game hides thousands of lines of code behind an inviting interface and an immersive experience. I want to do the same for Ciena's customers: take advanced networking technology and explain it in terms of what it means for their business.

Across my projects and jobs, the work I've enjoyed most has always been the customer-facing side:

- On Robo Cage, a multiplayer arena shooter built by a team of four, I pitched the game to 30 peers and faculty each sprint. I positioned it alongside top sellers like Overwatch and Apex Legends, framed features like our catch-up mechanics as player benefits, and backed every claim with a live demo.
- As a Student Manager at RIT Catering, I consulted with clients on events of up to 200 guests and adapted each event to their needs. I went beyond professional small talk to make clients feel comfortable, so they trusted me with any request or concern. Those relationships led to repeat bookings from 5 clients who requested me specifically.
- As President of the RIT Badminton Club, I grew our tournament by 15% to 100+ players. The key selling point was a redesigned bracket that gave players more matches for their entry fee, making the trip worth it for players traveling from long distances. This tournament also generated $1,500 in profit for the club.

These experiences showed me that I do my best work when I'm listening to people, solving their problems, and earning their trust. That is why I want to be in sales.

Hearing from Ivan Lai, who has built a 20+ year career at Ciena, showed me how much the company invests in its people. I would love to bring my user-first perspective, technical curiosity, and tenacity to this program.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

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STRENGTHS

- **Strengths:** Client Relationship Building; Consultative Problem Solving; Technical Presentations & Demos; Translating Technical Concepts; Cross-Functional Collaboration; Adaptability

EDUCATION

Rochester Institute of Technology **Aug. 2026**
Bachelor of Science, Game Design and Development *Rochester, NY*

- **GPA: 3.6/4.0** *Cum Laude*, Dean's List

PROJECTS

Robo Cage **Jun. 2025 - Present**
3D Artist & UI/UX Designer (Team of 4) *Remote*

- Partnered with a 3-person cross-functional team to deliver a real-time multiplayer FPS in Unity (C#), aligning art, UI, and engineering around a client-server architecture (Steamworks).
- Investigated the team's gameplay code independently to integrate UI, translating raw game data into clear, real-time visuals that improved player decision-making.
- Defined the game's value proposition as a fast-paced, chaotic arena shooter with high replayability through an upgrade system, using playtest feedback each sprint to prioritize the fixes and features that strengthened it.
- Pitched and demoed the game to 30 peers and faculty each sprint, highlighting player benefits like catch-up mechanics and positioning it alongside top-selling shooter games to show a large and proven target market.

Twilight Tower **Aug. 2024 - October 2024**
Game Developer, 2D Artist (Team of 2) *Rochester, NY*

- Engineered game state and player state systems in Godot to bring a light-based combat concept to life, turning a design idea into a working, playable feature.
- Collaborated with a partner to design levels and integrate 2D art, animation, and sound assets, delivering a complete product from concept to launch.

WORK EXPERIENCE

RIT Catering **Aug. 2024 - May 2026**
Student Manager *Rochester, NY*

- Consulted with clients to assess each event's unique setup and service needs, adapting plans for everything from casual buffets to formal plated dinners of up to 200 guests, all while building trusted client relationships leading to repeat bookings from 5 clients.
- Delegated tasks across a team of 5 staff and adjusted roles on the fly to keep high-stakes events on schedule, including dinners for the University President and Board of Trustees.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

RIT Badminton Club **Jan. 2023 - Jun. 2026**
President, Executive Board *Rochester, NY*

- Spearheaded and grew RIT OPEN 2026 participation by 15% to 100+ players by running an Instagram campaign, personally recruiting 5+ partner colleges, and switching to a waterfall bracket that guaranteed more play time and made the entry fee feel worthwhile for the players.
- Presented weekly updates and instructions to 50+ members, tailoring communication to keep a diverse group informed and engaged.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** C++; C#; Python; SQL; JavaScript; HTML; CSS
- **Tools & Environments:** Jira; Visual Studio; VS Code; Unity; Godot; Figma, Maya, Blender